Supplementary Materials for "Public Goods and the Press: Policy Implications of Disparities in Local Political News"

Michael Auslen*

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A Newspaper Text Coverage

This appendix reports the availability of newspaper text data in the archive. I first report the number of years between 1992-2016 for which I have text coverage for any newspaper in each Metropolitan Statistical Area (MSA) in Figure A1. Then, Figure A2 reports the number of papers available in each MSA for any period of time. Not all MSAs are included in the map; only those for which at least one paper-year exists in the dataset.

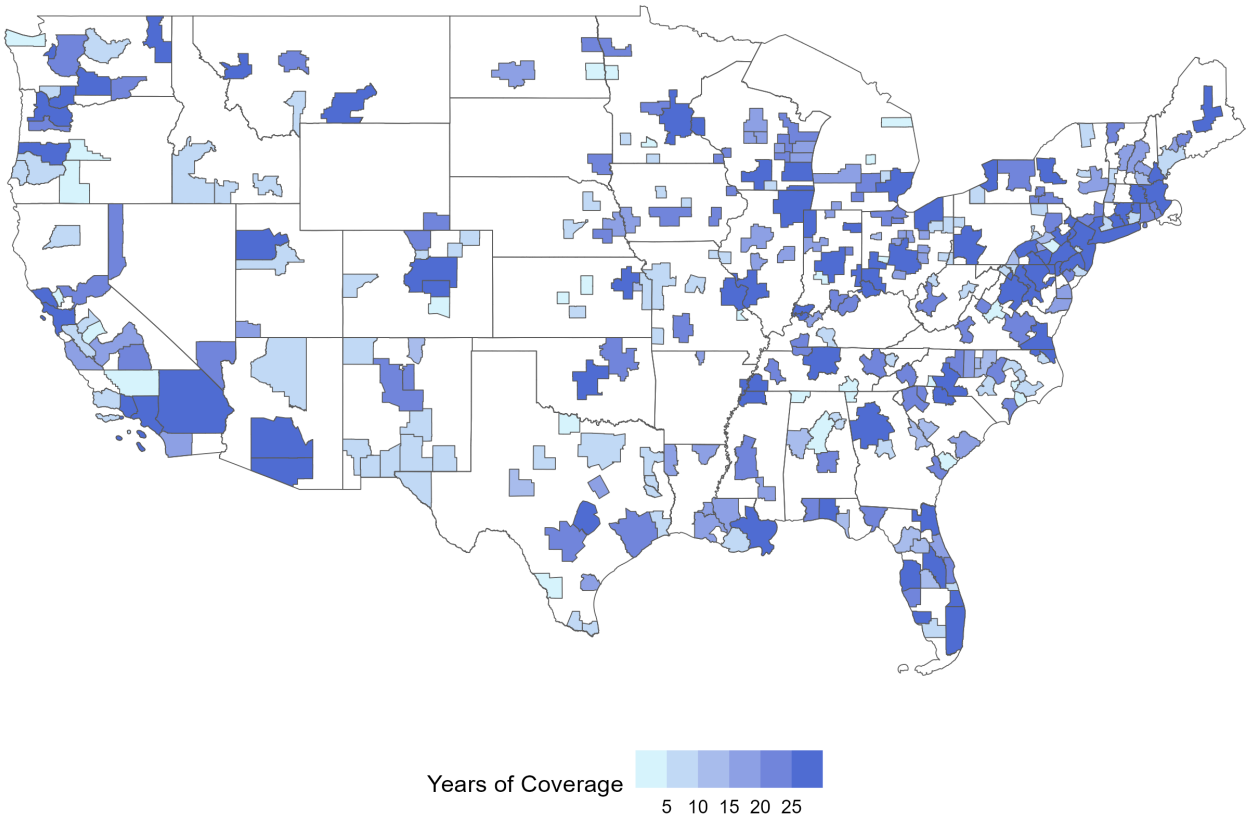
B Comparing Text-Based and Location-Based Measures

Figure A3 displays the cumulative difference of using this text-based method versus location-based approaches on a national scale. Focusing on the papers in the text archive to allow a complete comparison, the gray bar identifies the total number of newspaper headquarters cities in the dataset. The green bar shows the corresponding number of these municipalities that have at least one newspaper, using data collected by **?**. These values are essentially the same with some small measurement error. However, a considerable proportion of these municipalities are never covered when looking at the newspaper text. While it is true that most are covered monthly or weekly, many are not.

The bottom panel of Figure A3 shows what is missed by using the text approach. These are municipalities in the MSA of newspapers included in the top panel, where the text reveals some amount of local politics coverage. Potentially hundreds or thousands of newspapers would be left out of a location-based analysis.

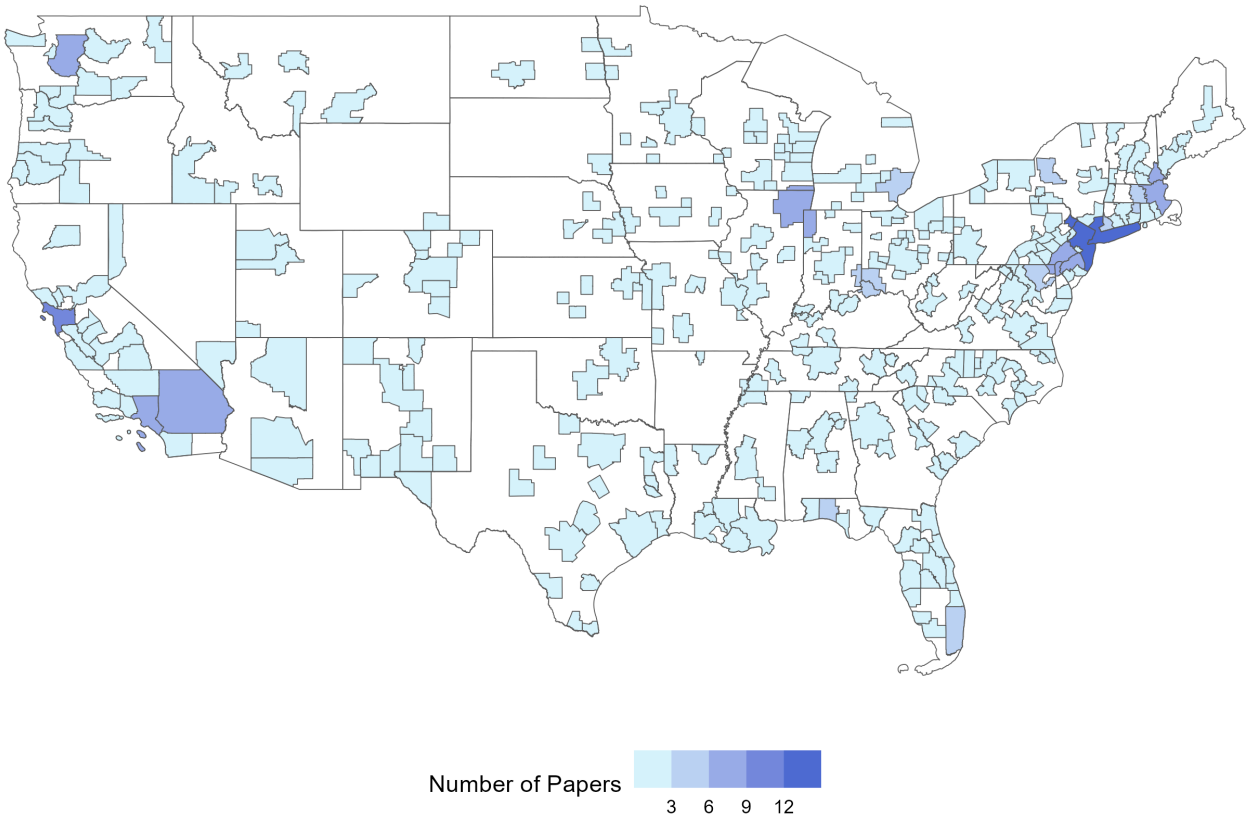
*Postdoctoral Fellow, Department of Government, University of Texas at Austin. Email: mauslen@utexas.edu. URL: `https://michaelauslen.com`.

Figure A1: Text Archive Coverage: MSAs by Years of Coverage



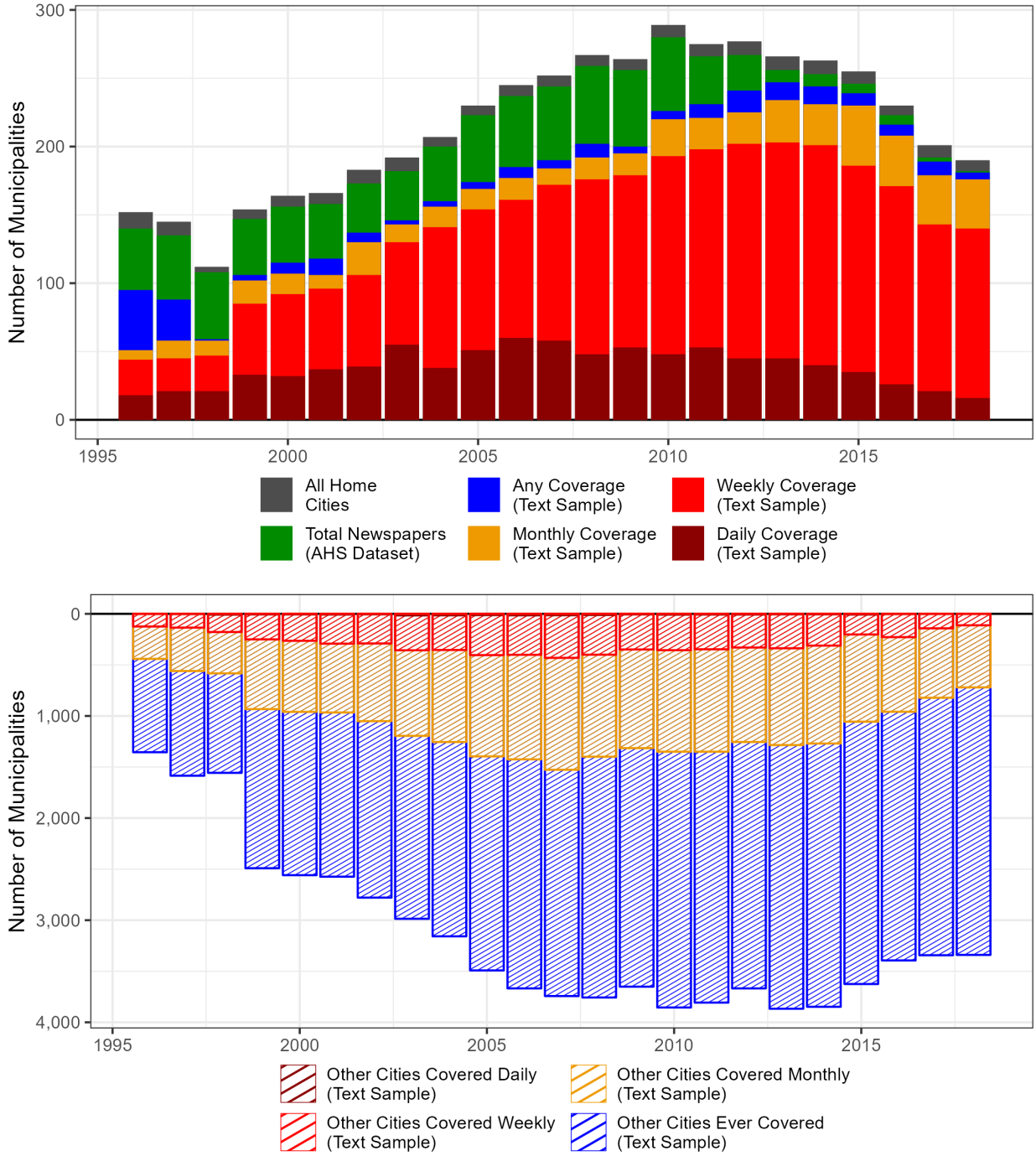
Note: This map shows all MSAs in the text dataset and the number of years for which at least one newspaper is present.

Figure A2: Text Archive Coverage: MSAs by Number of Papers



Note: This map shows all MSAs in the text dataset and the total number of newspapers that ever appear in the archive.

Figure A3: Comparing Text- and Location-Based Approaches for Measuring Local Politics Coverage



Note: The top panel compares the number of newspaper headquarters cities from the text archive that correspond to a newspaper in the dataset of newspaper closures from **?** (in green). The bar in blue shows the number of these municipal governments that are covered at least once, according to the text archive; orange reports the number covered monthly; and red the number covered weekly. The bottom panel shows the local government coverage that would not be included in the location-based approach but does appear in the text, with bars for weekly (red), monthly (orange), and any (blue) coverage.

References